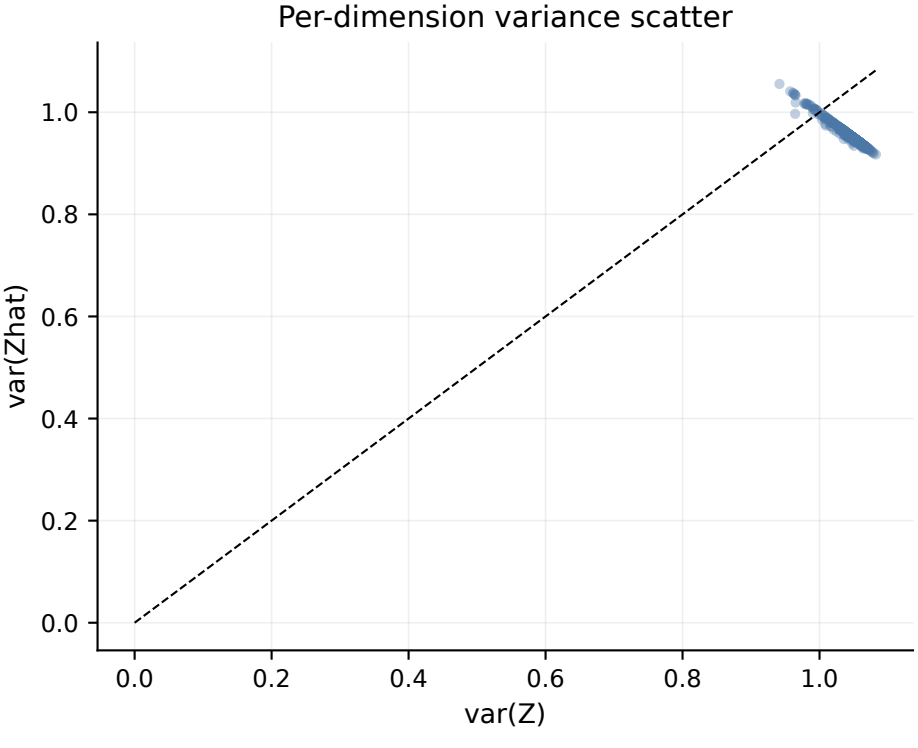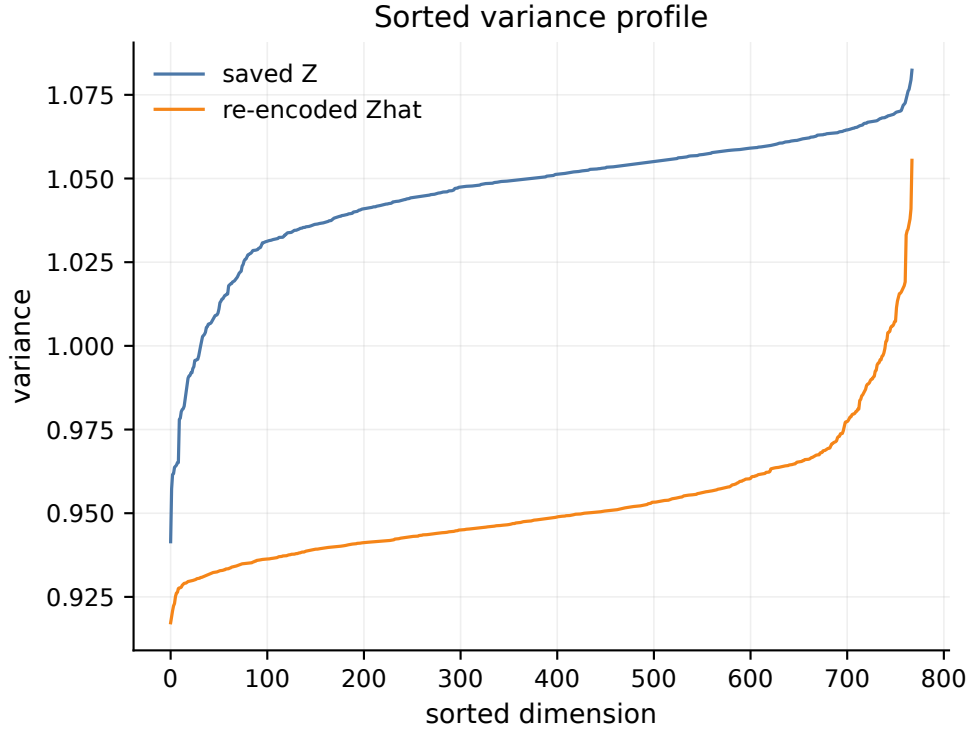Per-dimension variance: pooled semantic